

POST-LAUNCH PERFORMANCE REVIEW

Did 5G move the needle?

WaveCon's 5G launch: impact on revenue, customers, market share and plans

15

cities

13

prepaid plans

8

months of data

5

operators tracked

Jan-Sep 2022 · Before vs. after the May 2022 launch





EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

5G raised value per user, but we lost customers and market share

Q1

Revenue impact

Revenue slipped to ₹1,589.7 Cr from ₹1,597.7 Cr, while the market grew 6.8%. We were the only operator to lose share.

-0.5%
revenue

Q2

Underperforming KPI

Active users fell 8.3% (about 17 L fewer a month) and unsubscribes rose 23.5%. Only ARPU (+11.0%) kept revenue flat.

-8.3%
active users

Q3

Plan winners & laggards

p1 grew 31.7% and new plans p11/p12 took off. Low-data and talk-time plans p4, p5 and p6 shrank 18–35%.

+31.7%
p1 revenue

Q4

Most affected plan

p7 (25 GB 3G/4G combo) lost 73% of its revenue, and it fell in every city. Retire it and move its users to a 5G data pack.

-73%
p7 revenue

Q5

Discontinued plans

p8, p9 and p10 were retired. They were the three lowest earners and all short-validity packs. Their replacements, p11–p13, now earn 4.2× as much.

4.2×
new vs. retired



SCOPE & APPROACH

We compared the four months before launch with the four months after

BEFORE 5G

AFTER 5G



Matched month pairs, as in the dashboard's Month Comparison: Jan ↔ Jun · Feb ↔ Jul · Mar ↔ Aug · Apr ↔ Sep. The launch month (May) is not in the dataset.



Company KPIs

Revenue, ARPU, active users and unsubscribed users for WaveCon across 15 cities, month by month.



Market

Total market value and market share for WaveCon, its rivals PIO, Britel and Dadafone, and smaller operators.



Plans

Revenue from 13 prepaid plans by city and month, including 3 retired and 3 newly launched plans.

Notes: ARPU is the average of city-month ARPU, which is how the dashboard calculates it. Plan revenue only covers the tracked plans, so it does not add up exactly to total company revenue.



Revenue went flat after launch: 5G gave the top line no lift

Total revenue change

-0.5%

-₹8.0 Cr over four months

Before 5G (Jan–Apr) ₹1,597.7 Cr

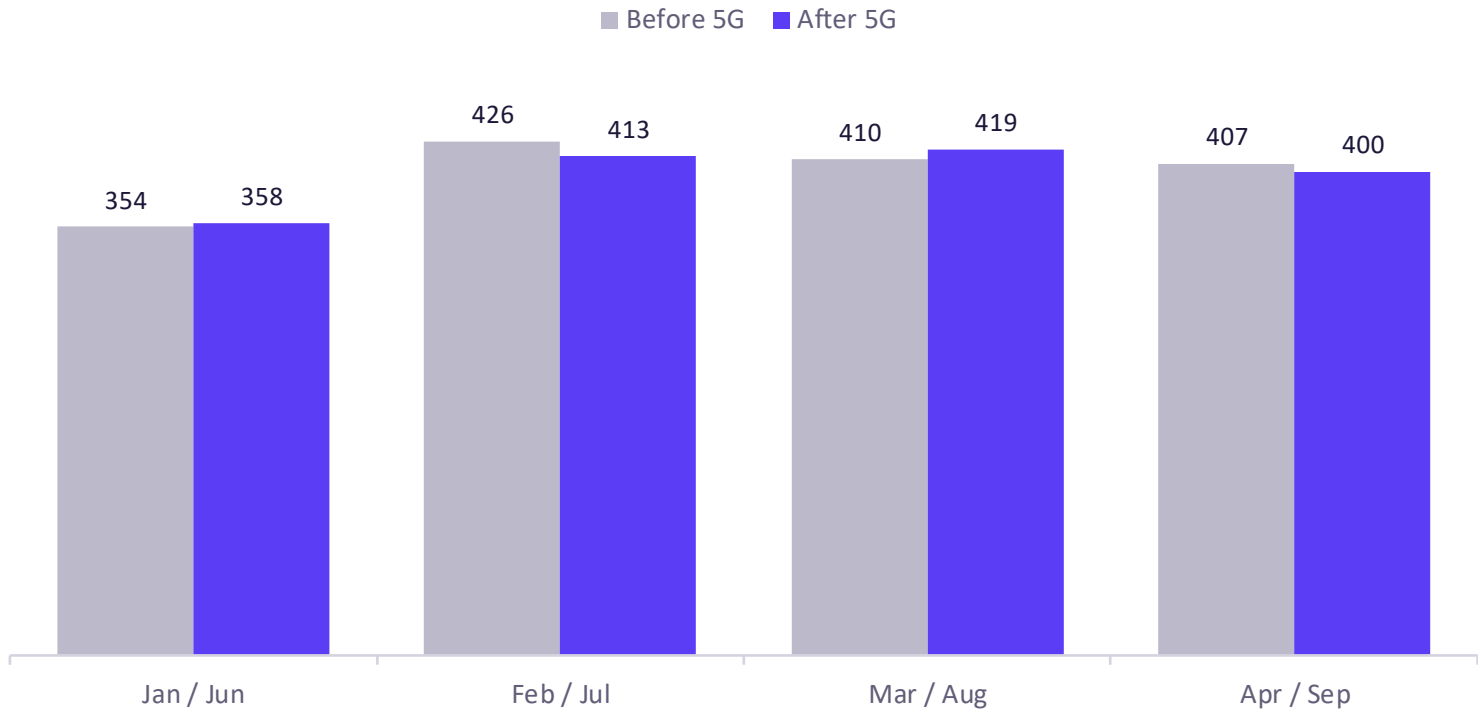
After 5G (Jun–Sep) ₹1,589.7 Cr

Avg. monthly revenue ₹399 → ₹397 Cr

6 of 15 cities declined

Delhi -2.8% · Chennai -2.6% · Ahmedabad -2.0%

Monthly revenue, ₹ Cr (matched month pairs)



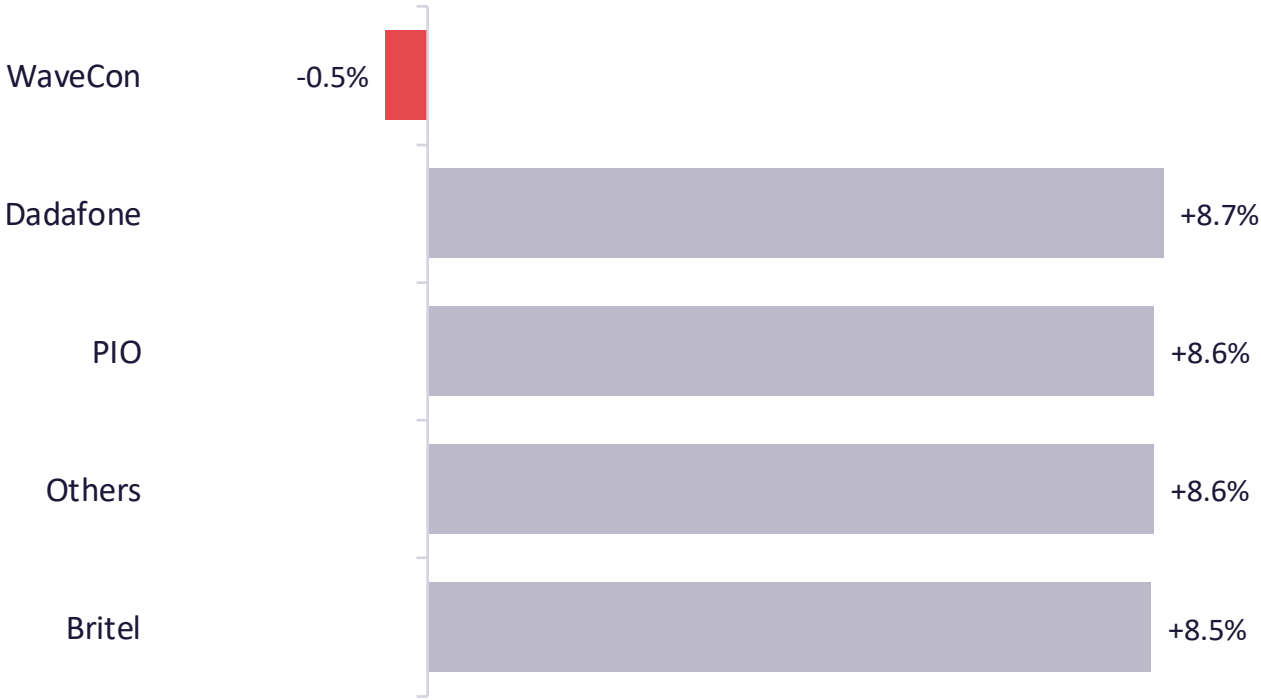
Change by month pair: Jan / Jun +0.9% · Feb / Jul -3.0% · Mar / Aug +2.1% · Apr / Sep -1.7%



Flat is a loss: the market grew 6.8% and every rival grew about 8.5%

Revenue growth after the 5G launch, by operator

Operator revenue = city market value × market share



PIO (+0.60 pp) and Britel (+0.46 pp) took most of the share we lost.

20.2% → 18.9%

WaveCon market share (−1.35 pp)

15 of 15

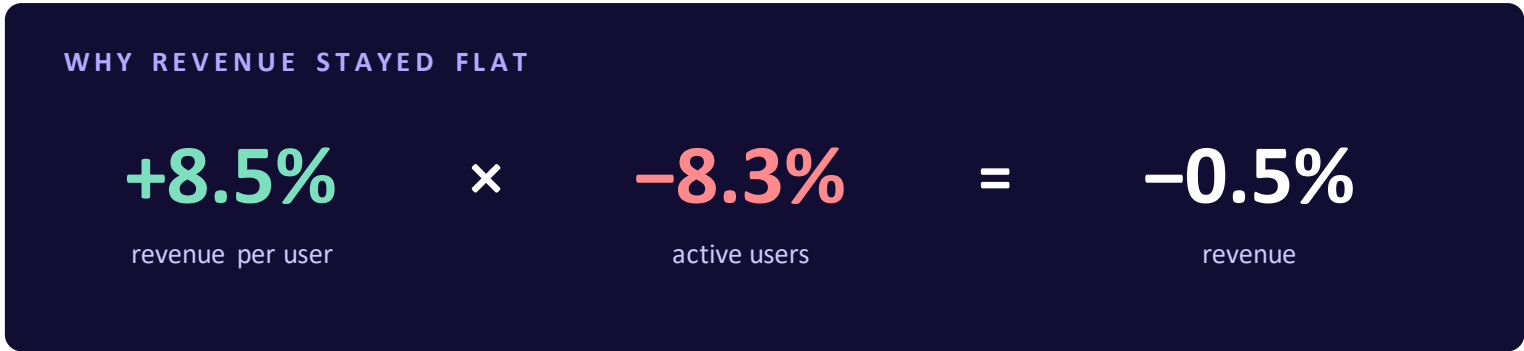
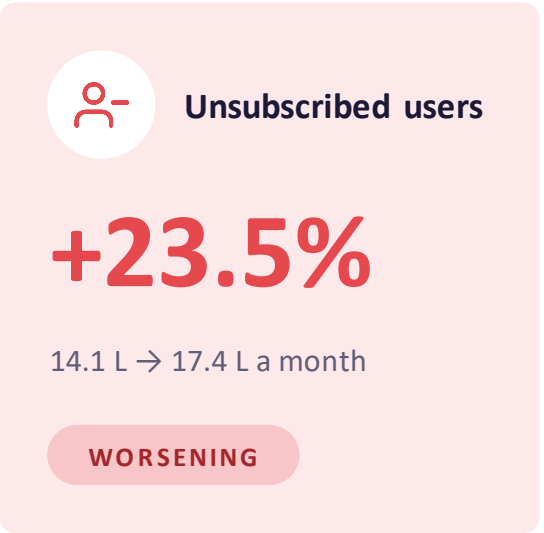
cities where we lost share (−1.3 to −1.5 pp each)

₹116 Cr

revenue we would have added by holding our pre-launch share in each city



Active users is the KPI that broke; ARPU is what kept revenue up

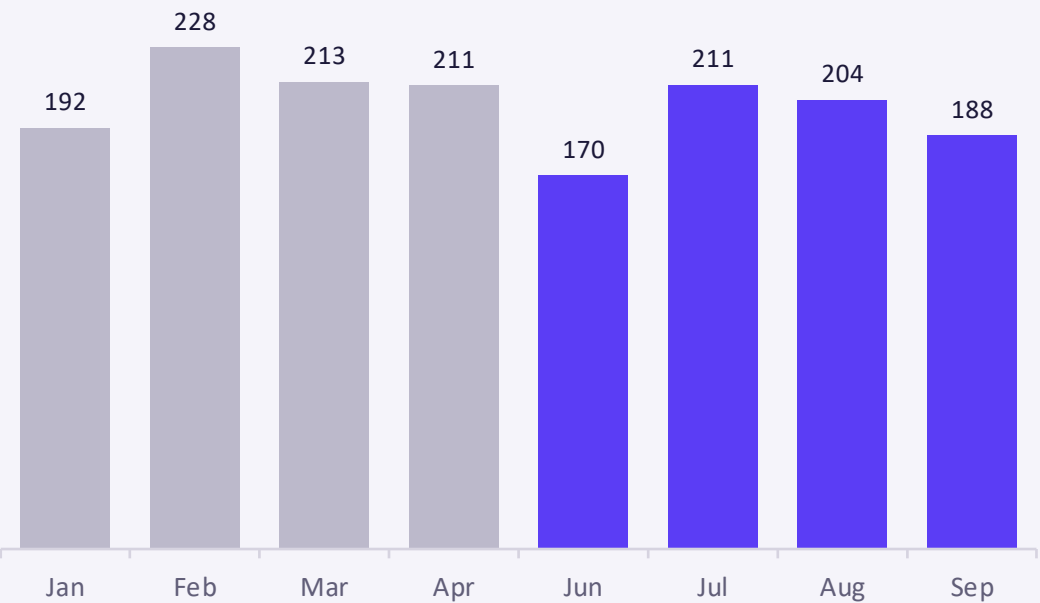




Users slumped at launch and stayed 8% lower, while churn jumped

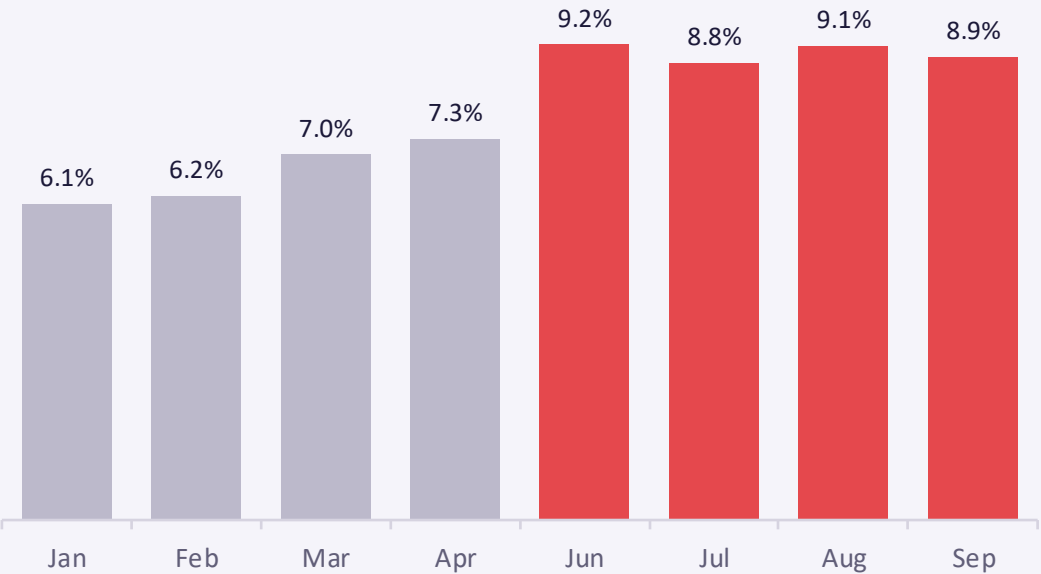
Active users by month (lakh)

■ Before 5G ■ After 5G



Unsubscribe rate by month (% of active users)

■ Before 5G ■ After 5G



Read-across: June, the first month after launch, was the lowest month for users (169.9 L, -19.4% vs. April). Churn was already rising before launch (6.1% → 7.3%) and then jumped to about 9%. The launch made an existing problem worse.



12 of 15 cities lost users, 14 saw more churn, and all 15 lost share

City	Revenue, Jan–Sep (₹ Cr)	Revenue Δ	ARPU Δ	Active users Δ	Unsubscribed Δ	Market share Δ
Mumbai	489.5	+0.3%	+17.4%	−14.4%	−12.6%	−1.33 pp
Delhi	387.2	−2.8%	+18.2%	−17.6%	+16.6%	−1.39 pp
Kolkata	384.4	−0.4%	+5.0%	−4.7%	+27.8%	−1.27 pp
Bangalore	338.6	+0.8%	+19.6%	−13.9%	+20.7%	−1.35 pp
Chennai	296.4	−2.6%	−2.6%	+0.4%	+36.9%	−1.43 pp
Pune	259.8	+0.4%	−12.9%	+18.1%	+55.3%	−1.44 pp
Hyderabad	235.7	−1.3%	+10.6%	−7.5%	+38.1%	−1.26 pp
Ahmedabad	187.1	−2.0%	+21.8%	−18.9%	+16.3%	−1.33 pp
Jaipur	140.9	+1.0%	+7.3%	−5.5%	+52.5%	−1.42 pp
Lucknow	130.8	+1.8%	+8.0%	+2.6%	+77.9%	−1.41 pp
Patna	98.2	+1.5%	+20.3%	−16.1%	+10.5%	−1.30 pp
Coimbatore	91.4	+0.1%	+8.3%	−9.3%	+26.5%	−1.32 pp
Chandigarh	61.2	−0.6%	+10.0%	−5.0%	+45.6%	−1.33 pp
Gurgaon	54.6	+1.5%	+16.9%	−13.1%	+12.1%	−1.46 pp
Raipur	31.5	+1.1%	+22.3%	−16.7%	+10.5%	−1.28 pp

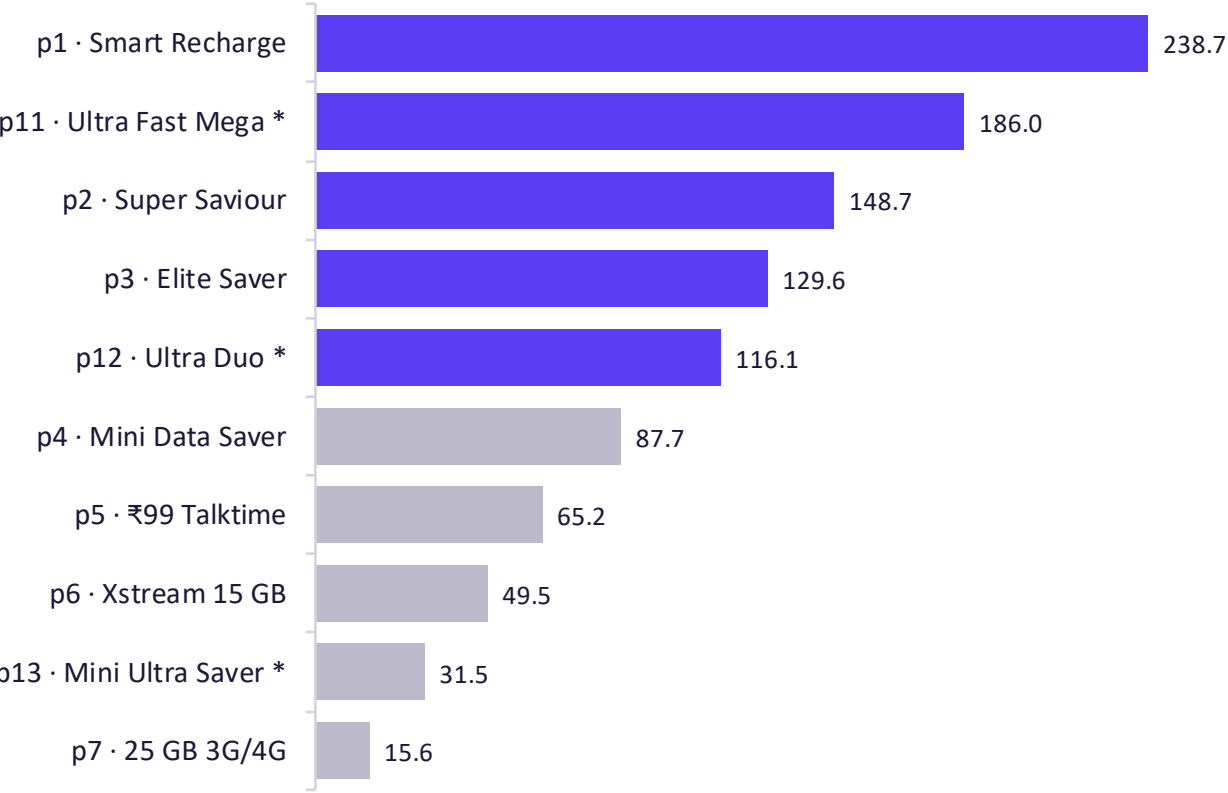
■ favourable ■ unfavourable Darker shade and bold = move of 10% or more (1.4 pp or more for share). Sorted by revenue.



Five plans earn 77% of plan revenue, led by p1 and the new 5G packs

Plan revenue after the 5G launch (Jun–Sep), ₹ Cr

■ Top 5 ■ Other plans * launched with 5G



p1 is the growth engine

Smart Recharge (2 GB/day, 3 months) grew 31.7% (+₹57.4 Cr) and rose in all 15 cities (+16% to +53%).



New 5G packs took off at once

p11 Ultra Fast Mega (3 GB/day) and p12 Ultra Duo (1.8 GB/day) earned ₹302.1 Cr in four months, 28% of plan revenue.



p2 and p3 are a stable core

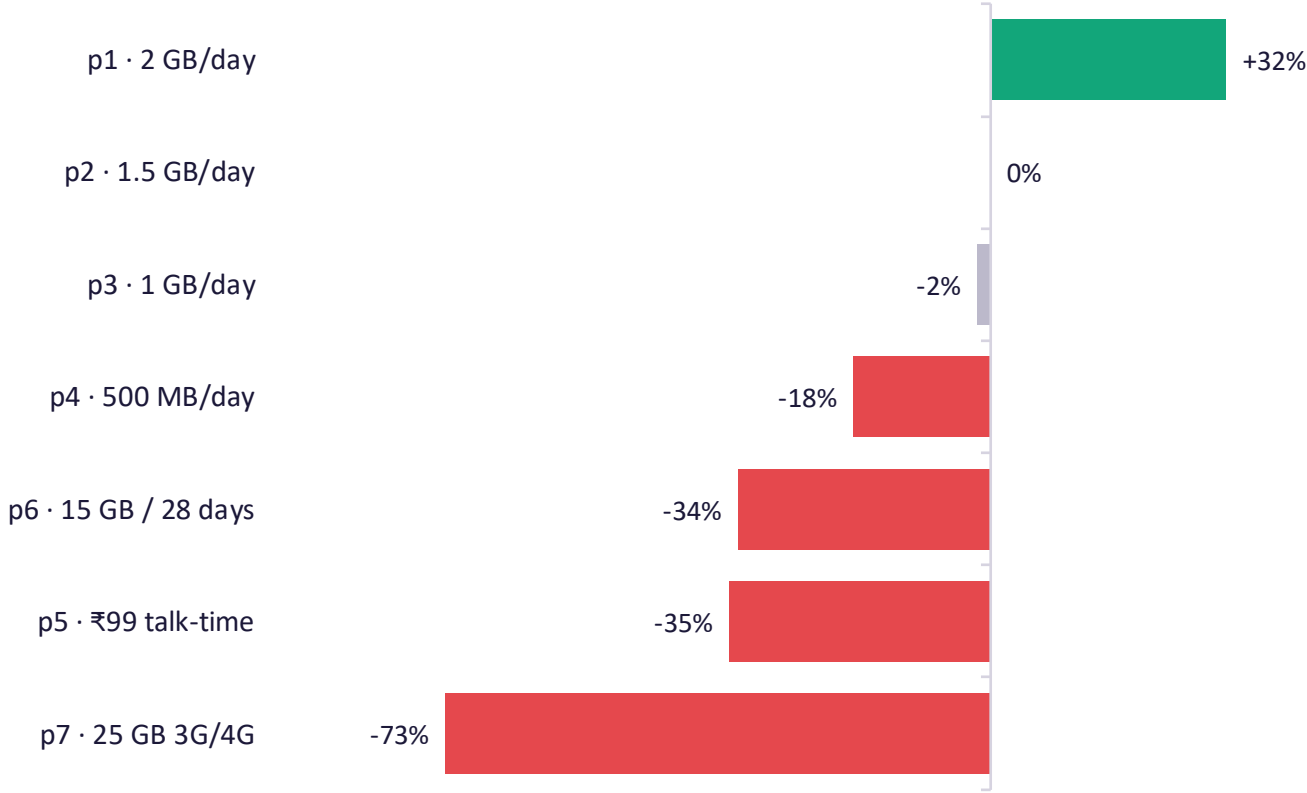
Super Saviour (flat) and Elite Saver (–1.8%) held steady at ₹278 Cr combined.



The less data a plan offers, the harder it fell after the 5G launch

Revenue change after launch, plans ordered by data allowance

■ growing ■ flat (within ±2%) ■ declining



Underperformers

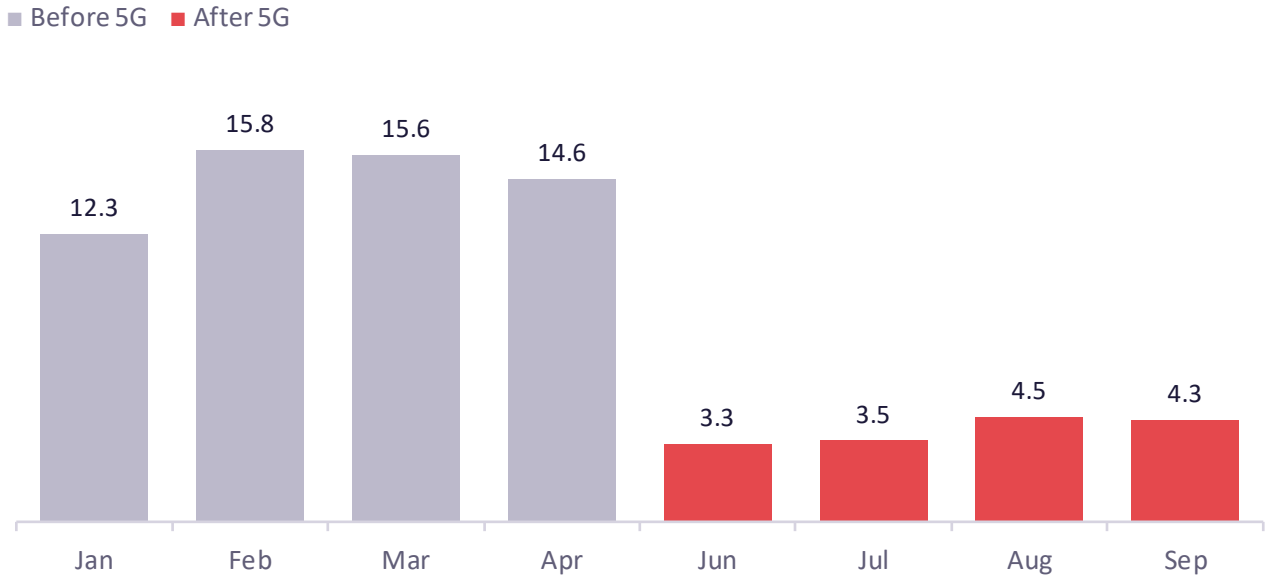
p7	25 GB Combo 3G/4G Data Pack ₹58.2 Cr → ₹15.6 Cr	-73%
p5	Rs. 99 Full Talktime Combo ₹100.5 Cr → ₹65.2 Cr	-35%
p6	Xstream 15 GB / 28 days ₹74.9 Cr → ₹49.5 Cr	-34%
p4	Mini Data Saver 500 MB/day ₹107.5 Cr → ₹87.7 Cr	-18%

Together these four lost ₹123.3 Cr. The new p13 (750 MB/day) is the weakest 5G launch at ₹31.5 Cr, which fits the pattern: low-data plans are losing appeal.



p7 lost 73% of its revenue: retire it and move its users to 5G

p7 monthly revenue, ₹ Cr



₹14.6 → ₹3.9 Cr

average monthly revenue

15 of 15

cities down, by 65–79%

6.6% → 1.5%

share of plan revenue

RECOMMENDATION

Discontinue p7 in its current form and move its users to a 5G data pack

- Obsolete promise** It is sold as a 3G/4G pack, which makes little sense on a 5G network.
- Product, not market** Revenue fell by a similar amount in every city, so the problem is the plan itself, not any local market.
- Low exit cost** It now earns only ₹3.9 Cr a month, 1.5% of plan revenue.
- Keep the customers** Offer p7 users an upgrade to a 5G-ready bulk-data pack (e.g., p12 or p13) before switching it off.

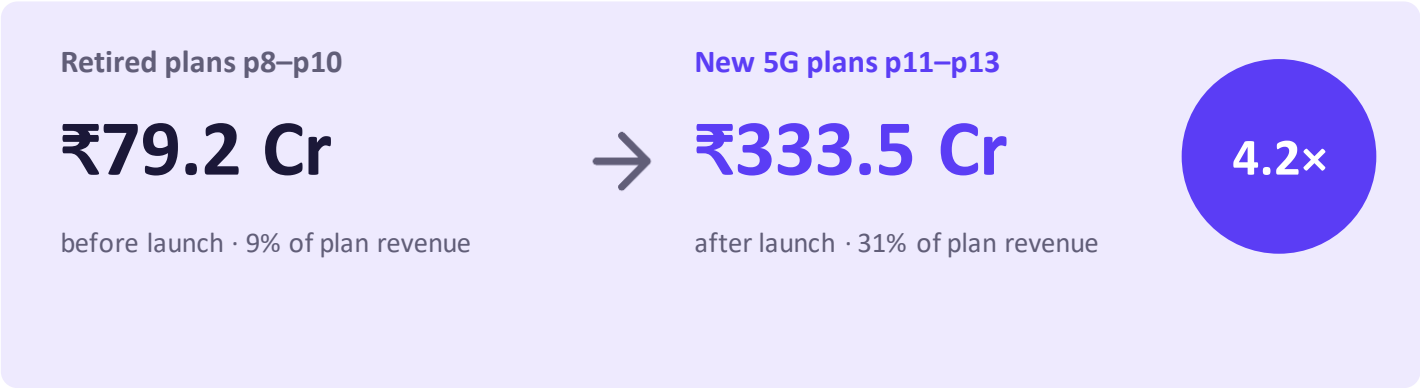


Three weak plans were retired; their 5G replacements earn 4.2× as much

Retired after the launch (no revenue from June)

p8	Daily Saviour 1 GB/day · 1-day validity	₹43.4 Cr rank #8 of 10
p9	Combo TopUp ₹14.95 talk-time + 300 MB	₹22.7 Cr rank #9 of 10
p10	Big Combo Pack 6 GB/day · 3-day validity	₹13.1 Cr rank #10 of 10

Pre-launch revenue, Jan–Apr 2022. Rank among the 10 plans on sale before launch.



Why they were cut

- Bottom three earners:** They ranked last among the 10 plans on sale, bringing in just ₹79.2 Cr together.
- Short-validity packs:** They lasted 1–3 days or were one-off top-ups, so each recharge was worth little and kept customers for a short time.
- Space for 5G packs:** Replaced by long-validity, high-data plans (p11: 3 GB/day for 80 days, p12: 1.8 GB/day for 55 days) that suit 5G use.



Four cities tell the story, and Mumbai shows what good looks like

Mumbai

THE MODEL

15%

Revenue share

+17.4%

ARPU

-12.6%

Unsubscribed

Our #1 market, and the only city where unsubscribes fell. Copy its retention playbook in other cities.

Delhi

BIGGEST LOSS

-2.8%

Revenue

-17.6%

Active users

4.8 L

Fewer users a month

Our #2 market had the worst revenue decline and the largest drop in users. Make it the first win-back market.

Pune

CHEAP GROWTH

+18.1%

Active users

-12.9%

ARPU

+55.3%

Unsubscribed

The only big user gain came with the only big ARPU fall and high churn. Check whether discounting is buying low-value users.

Lucknow

CHURN HOTSPOT

+1.8%

Revenue

+2.6%

Active users

+77.9%

Unsubscribed

Revenue grew more here than anywhere, but unsubscribes rose 78%, the most of any city. Check network experience here.



RECOMMENDATIONS

Five moves to turn 5G into growth

1

Win back lost users

Run targeted retention and win-back offers in Delhi, Mumbai, Bangalore, Ahmedabad, which have about 15 L fewer active users a month between them.

KPI: Active users

2

Fix what drives churn

Find out why unsubscribes jumped in Lucknow (+78%), Pune (+55%) and Jaipur (+52%): network quality, device readiness or pricing.

KPI: Unsubscribes

3

Scale the winners

Put marketing behind p1, p11 and p12. Offer p4, p5 and p6 users an upgrade to a data-heavy 5G pack.

KPI: Plan mix

4

Retire p7

Switch off the 3G/4G combo and move its users to a 5G bulk-data pack with an upgrade offer.

KPI: Plan portfolio

5

Win back market share

We are the only operator losing share. Compete with PIO and Britel on 5G coverage and value. About ₹116 Cr is at stake.

KPI: Market share



NORTH-STAR TARGET

Get back to ~211 L active users a month while keeping revenue per user above ₹205

Today: 193 L a month at ₹205 revenue per user

THE BOTTOM LINE

5G made each customer worth more. Now we have to keep them.

+11.0%

ARPU

-8.3%

active users

-1.35 pp

market share

Thank you · Questions?

